

SpiderPlus & Co. (4192.T)

TSE Growth | Information & Communication — Construction Tech SaaS | Market Cap: JPY 10.0B

BUY

Current: ¥283 (Jul 16, 2026) | **Target: ¥375** | **Upside: +32.5%**

Bull (peer median 3.4x EV/S): ¥517 (+83%) | Framework: EV/Sales re-rating to profitable-SaaS floor (2.4x), corroborated by DCF exit-multiple (¥371)

Metric	Value	Metric	Value
EV/Sales (FY25A)	1.73x	Peer floor / median	2.41x / 3.43x
Net Cash	¥1.56B (16% of mkt cap)	Reported churn	0.9% (co. disclosure)
FY26 Rev guidance	+20.5%	Q1 FY26 Rev growth	+8.8% YoY
Q1 FY26 Op. Profit	¥5M (first black Q1)	FY25 Op. Profit	-¥11M (~breakeven)
ARR growth (latest)	~+9% YoY	vs 2021 high ¥2,629	-89% 10Y low ¥234 (Mar-26)

The Trade

Market Misperception: The market prices SpiderPlus below the floor of every profitable Japanese SaaS comparable — implied EV/Sales of 1.73x against a five-company peer distribution running from 2.41x (SMS) to 6.17x (eWeLL). This is a fallen 2021 IPO darling, down 89% from its ¥2,629 high, that printed a 10-year low of ¥234 as recently as March 2026. ARR growth decelerated from +30% (H1 2024) to roughly +9%, and the market has extrapolated that deceleration as permanent: a structurally sub-scale, ex-growth, loss-making SaaS. Institutional attention is near zero — the label has not been re-examined since it was applied.

Underlying Reality: The deceleration was self-inflicted, not structural. Management deliberately cut growth spend to reach profitability — and the inflection is now printed: FY2025 operating profit of -¥11M (effective breakeven, vs -¥519M in FY2024), followed by Q1 FY2026 operating profit of +¥5M, the company's first black first quarter, on +8.8% revenue growth. What remains is a vertical SaaS with reported churn of 0.9%, rising data lock-in (drawings, inspection records, site photos accumulate with tenure), a capital and business alliance with Infomart (announced May 27, 2026) opening a construction back-office distribution channel, and structural demand from the 2024 overtime-cap regulation that is forcing construction-site digitization.

Price Driver — August Q2 Print and the Label Rewrite: The mid-August H1 report is the first checkpoint where ARR re-acceleration can show up in the numbers. Two consecutive profitable quarters plus visible ARR re-acceleration forces the label to migrate from "loss-making SaaS" to "profitable vertical SaaS" — and with it, the multiple from 1.73x toward the 2.4x floor of the profitable peer set. The re-rating does not require the company to become cheap-to-fair on DCF; it requires the market to apply the same yardstick it already applies to SMS, LightWorks, Toyokumo, Smaregi and eWeLL.

What This Trade Is Not (Read This First): Our reverse DCF says the current ¥283 already embeds a growth multiplier of roughly 1.6x our Base path — a ~32% Year-1 revenue trajectory versus +20.5% guidance and +8.8% Q1 actual. An investor who believes only guidance-level growth, sustained, should not own this stock: on that assumption our perpetuity-growth DCF values it at ¥131. This is explicitly a re-acceleration bet, resolved by evidence over the next two prints, and our target rests on the multiple framework — not on the PGM engine, which structurally undervalues companies at a profitability inflection (near-zero FCF base, terminal-value dominated).

Investment Decision: BUY with a target of ¥375, triangulated from two independent methods that land within 1% of each other: the cheapest profitable SaaS peer multiple (2.41x EV/Sales = ¥376) and our DCF exit-multiple value (¥371). Bull case ¥517 at the peer median (3.43x). Net cash of ¥1.56B (16% of market cap) and a cost base now below revenue limit the downside of thesis failure. This recommendation is wrong if: (a) ARR growth remains single-digit through H2 FY2026, (b) churn deteriorates above 1.5%, or (c) operating profit returns to red for two consecutive quarters.

Sector Context: Why SpiderPlus Is Mispriced

A. Japanese SaaS — EV/Sales Positioning

Against profitable Japanese SaaS comparables, SpiderPlus trades below the entire distribution. Every company in the peer set has crossed into sustained profitability; SpiderPlus crossed that line in FY2025-Q1 FY2026, but the multiple has not followed. The position z-score versus the peer inter-quartile range is approximately -3.7 — not "cheap end of the range" but outside the range entirely.

Company	Ticker	EV/Sales	Justified 4192 Price	vs Current ¥283
SMS (floor)	2175.T	2.41x	¥376	+33%
LightWorks (25th %ile)	4267.T	3.06x	¥466	+65%
Toyokumo (median)	4058.T	3.43x	¥517	+83%
Smaregi (75th %ile)	4431.T	3.52x	¥529	+87%
eWeLL (max)	5038.T	6.17x	¥895	+216%
SpiderPlus (implied)	4192.T	1.73x	—	—

Justified price = (multiple × FY25A revenue ¥4,895M + net cash ¥1,559M) / 35.51M shares. Peer multiples per model dataset (trailing revenue basis).

Sources: company filings, market data as of model date; verify multiples at publication.

B. Construction DX — Regulation-Forced Demand

Japan's construction sector faces a structural labor squeeze: the April 2024 application of overtime caps to construction (the "2024 problem") made paper-based site inspection and drawing management workflows economically non-viable, while the workforce continues to age out. SPIDERPLUS is a site-inspection and drawing-management SaaS used across construction and plant engineering; its economics improve as each site's drawings, inspection records and photos accumulate on the platform. The Infomart alliance connects this site layer to the construction back-office layer (Infomart operates one of Japan's dominant B2B invoicing platforms with deep construction-sector penetration), creating a distribution channel that does not require SpiderPlus to rebuild the sales and marketing engine it just cut to reach profitability. Company-announced initiatives also include a DIS distribution relationship and an AI co-development with Konoike-gumi (per IR materials).

Three Structural Drivers

1. Profitability Inflection with Operating Leverage

Operating profit moved from -¥519M (FY2024, -12.7% OPM) to -¥11M (FY2025, effective breakeven) to +¥5M in Q1 FY2026 — the first profitable first quarter in the company's listed history. The cost base was reset below the revenue line while revenue continued to grow (+19.8% in FY2025). From this base, incremental SaaS revenue carries high contribution margin: our Base path has OPM scaling from 0.6% (FY2026) to 10.7% by FY2030 on guidance-level growth alone. Every point of growth above Base falls disproportionately to operating profit.

2. Channel Flywheel: Infomart Capital Alliance

The May 27, 2026 capital and business alliance with Infomart is the thesis catalyst. SpiderPlus decelerated because it stopped buying growth; the alliance substitutes a partner channel for the S&M spend it cut. Infomart's construction-sector client base is an installed distribution network for site-DX tooling, and the capital component signals commitment beyond a press-release partnership. Revenue contribution is realistically H2 FY2026 at the earliest and FY2027 in size — which is precisely why the market, anchored on trailing +9% ARR growth, has not priced it.

3. Industry-Specific Stickiness: 0.9% Churn and Data Lock-In

Construction SaaS retention is structurally advantaged: once a contractor's drawings, inspection histories and site photo archives live in SPIDERPLUS, migration means re-training field crews and abandoning accumulated records — a switching cost that rises with tenure. Reported churn of 0.9% means the revenue base is effectively a ratchet: new bookings are almost pure net adds, and any re-acceleration in gross bookings translates nearly one-for-one into ARR growth. This is the mechanism that makes the re-acceleration bet asymmetric.

What the Market Is Pricing (Reverse DCF)

We invert the DCF: holding our Base assumptions fixed, we scan the growth multiplier alpha (α) applied to the Base revenue path (Base Year-1 = +20%, tapering to +11% by Year 5, mirroring guidance) and solve for the α each price point implies. The current price requires believing growth roughly 60% above guidance-level, sustained across the projection window:

Growth multiplier (α)	Implied Y1 revenue growth	Implied share price	Interpretation
1.0 (Base = guidance path)	+20%	¥131	PGM value if guidance is the ceiling
1.3	+26%	¥199	Modest re-acceleration
1.5	+30%	¥257	Strong re-acceleration
≈1.59	~+32%	¥283 ← current price	What the market already believes
1.9	+38%	¥371	≈ DCF exit-multiple value

The bridge we must believe — from +8.8% to above +20.5%: Q1 revenue grew +8.8% against full-year guidance of +20.5%; the current price implies ~+32%. Three mechanisms close the gap. *First*, SaaS revenue recognition lags bookings: ARR added through the year is recognized H2-weighted, so a booking re-acceleration shows in revenue with a lag — guidance itself embeds this back-loading. *Second*, 0.9% churn puts a floor under net revenue retention: re-acceleration requires only a recovery in gross adds, not a fight against attrition. *Third*, the Infomart channel and related initiatives contribute from H2 FY2026 and in size from FY2027 — meaning the growth we believe exceeds Base is concentrated in the outer years, not in FY2026. We note honestly that the α engine applies one multiplier uniformly across all five years and cannot express this back-loaded shape; that limitation is exactly why our target rests on the multiple framework, with the reverse DCF serving as the disclosure of what must be true.

Catalyst Calendar

Date	Event	Scenario If Positive	Probability
Mid-Aug 2026	H1 FY2026 results (primary checkpoint)	ARR growth re-accelerates into low-teens+; second consecutive black quarter confirms label rewrite	MEDIUM-HIGH
H2 2026	Infomart alliance execution (joint offers, channel wins)	First partnership-sourced deals disclosed; validates distribution flywheel	MEDIUM
Feb 2027	FY2026 full-year results	First full profitable year in listed history; "loss-making SaaS" label formally dead	HIGH (if H1 on track)

Feb 2027	FY2027 guidance	Partnership revenue visible in guidance; justifies outer-year $\alpha > 1.5$	MEDIUM
Ongoing	Coverage initiation / renewed institutional attention	Stage migration from undiscovered; multiple converges toward peer set	LOW-MEDIUM (timing uncertain)

If-Then Logic: If the August print shows ARR growth back in the low-teens with operating profit still black, the label rewrite begins and the 2.41x floor (¥376) is achievable within 6–12 months. If FY2027 guidance then makes partnership revenue visible, the peer median ($3.43x = ¥517$) becomes the operative target. The recommendation becomes WRONG if ARR growth is still single-digit at the February 2027 full-year report — that would mean the Infomart channel is not converting and the deceleration is demand-side after all.

Valuation

Method	Fair Value	vs Current (¥283)	Role in Thesis
Reverse Comps — peer floor (2.41x EV/S)	¥376	+33%	Primary anchor
DCF — Exit Multiple	¥371	+31%	Independent corroboration
Comps — peer median (3.43x EV/S)	¥517	+83%	Bull case
DCF — PGM, Base ($\alpha = 1.0$)	¥131	-54%	Honest floor if growth = guidance only
Target (floor × exit triangulation)	¥375	+32.5%	—

Why the PGM–Exit divergence is information, not noise: The perpetuity-growth DCF discounts a company whose free cash flow base is approximately zero at the valuation date — the entire value sits in the terminal assumption, and small changes in the perpetuity inputs swing the output violently (¥131 vs ¥371 on the same model). At a profitability inflection this divergence is expected: PGM tells you what the company is worth if today's economics persist; the exit multiple tells you what it is worth if it becomes an ordinary member of its peer set. Our BUY is a bet on the second framing, and we present the first so the reader can price the disagreement. Multiple-migration scenario: label rewrite alone ($1.73x \rightarrow 2.41x$) = +33%; rewrite plus visible partnership growth ($\rightarrow 3.43x$) = +83%; the max multiple in the set (eWeLL, $6.17x = ¥895$) is not our case and would require growth economics SpiderPlus has not demonstrated.

Competitive Moat and Landscape

The moat is data gravity plus field habit. Each project uploaded to SPIDERPLUS — drawings, inspection checklists, photo records — raises the cost of leaving; field crews trained on the tool resist replacement tooling mid-project; and 0.9% churn is the printed evidence that the lock-in works. The Infomart alliance extends this into workflow adjacency (site records flowing toward invoicing and back-office). The honest counterweight: SpiderPlus is not alone in construction DX. Private, well-funded competitors — ANDPAD and Photoruction most prominently — pursue broader construction-management platforms, and a bundled horizontal winner is the structural threat to a point-solution vertical. Our thesis does not require SpiderPlus to win the category; it requires it to keep its installed base (churn says it does) and grow bookings through a channel it does not have to fund.

Risk Factors

Re-Acceleration Fails (HIGH). ARR growth stays single-digit: the deceleration proves demand-side, not spend-side. The label rewrite stalls at breakeven-SaaS and the multiple has no reason to migrate. Mitigation: ¥1.56B net cash and a cost base below revenue mean thesis failure is dead money more than capital loss; PGM floor ¥131 is the honest bear marker.

Competition from Funded Horizontal Platforms (MEDIUM-HIGH). ANDPAD / Photoruction bundle site management into broader suites; aggressive land-grab pricing could compress SpiderPlus's new-booking economics even while churn holds.

Partnership Execution and Capital-Alliance Terms (MEDIUM). Channel partnerships routinely underdeliver; the capital component may include future dilution or commercial terms not yet visible. Verify alliance terms in the definitive disclosures.

Liquidity (MEDIUM). TSE Growth listing, ~¥10B market cap, thin daily volume: institutional position building and exit are slow, and the same illiquidity that enables mispricing amplifies drawdowns on disappointment.

Construction Cycle (LOW-MEDIUM). A capex downturn slows new-site formation. Offset: regulation-driven adoption is compliance spend, historically more resilient than discretionary IT.

Recommendation De-Risk Conditions (EXPLICIT): Reassess this BUY if: (a) ARR growth remains below 10% through the H2 FY2026 print; (b) reported churn deteriorates above 1.5%; (c) operating profit is red for two consecutive quarters; or (d) the stock reaches ¥520+ without FY2027 partnership revenue visibility — at which point the re-rating has outrun its evidence and profits should be taken.

Financial Summary

(JPY M)	FY2024A	FY2025A	FY2026E (Co. Guide)	FY2026E (Model Base)	FY2027E	FY2028E	FY2029E	FY2030E
Revenue	4,086*	4,895	5,900	5,874	6,990	8,178	9,323	10,349
YoY Growth	—	+19.8%	+20.5%	+20.0%	+19.0%	+17.0%	+14.0%	+11.0%

Operating Profit	-519	-11	n.d. (black)	35	224	466	811	1,107
OPM	-12.7%	-0.2%	—	0.6%	3.2%	5.7%	8.7%	10.7%
Net Income	n.d.	-17	n.d.	—	—	—	—	—

**FY2024 revenue derived from disclosed operating profit (-¥519M) and OPM (-12.7%) per securities-report-based data; verify against tanshin before citation. FY2027E–FY2030E are the model Base path ($\alpha = 1.0$, guidance-mirroring), shown to make the operating-leverage shape explicit — they are not company guidance. KPI context: ARR ¥3,963M at H1 FY2024 (+30% YoY) per company results briefing; latest ARR growth ~+9%; reported churn 0.9%.*

Investment Summary

The market sees a broken, ex-growth SaaS and prices it below the floor of its profitable peer set. The reality is a company that traded growth for profitability, kept a 0.9%-churn installed base intact, and has just acquired a distribution channel it does not have to pay for. The August print is the first checkpoint; the label rewrite is the trade.

Disclaimer

This report has been prepared by an independent equity researcher for informational and educational purposes only. It does not constitute investment advice, a recommendation, or a solicitation to buy or sell any security. **The author holds a long position in SpiderPlus & Co. (4192.T).** Readers should take this interest into account when evaluating the analysis and conclusions presented here.

All analysis, opinions, and estimates are based on publicly available information as of July 16, 2026 and are subject to change without notice. Financial projections involve assumptions about future events that may not materialize; actual results may differ materially. Peer multiples and market data should be re-verified as of the publication date.

Financial data sourced from EDINET filings, SpiderPlus IR materials (tanshin, results briefings), and publicly available market data. Reverse-DCF engine, implied-multiple framework, Python pipeline and supporting code: github.com/Ryosuke0369/ryosuke-japanese-equity-research

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